Global Markets Trade Idea & Portfolio Review Casebook

A no-code markets portfolio project focused on FX and commodities trade idea generation, portfolio review, risk management, and macro-driven market analysis.

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Programme / Profile	MSc Finance | Markets-focused self-directed project
Market Coverage	FX (EUR/USD, GBP/USD, USD/JPY) and Commodities (Gold, Silver, Crude Oil)
Core Review Metrics	8 clients supported | ~20 trades reviewed weekly | 0.5% risk per trade | 1:2 target R:R

Prepared as a quality portfolio project to evidence global markets interest, structured analysis, risk discipline, and clear written communication.

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Executive Summary

This casebook presents a structured, no code approach to monitoring global financial markets, generating trade ideas, reviewing positions and portfolio exposure, and evaluating market decisions through disciplined post-trade analysis. The project has been designed to resemble the workflow expected in a junior markets, sales, or research environment: a repeatable process, clear rationale, strong risk discipline, and concise communication.

The casebook focuses on foreign exchange and commodities, two areas that are highly sensitive to macroeconomic developments, inflation expectations, central bank communication, geopolitics, and cross-asset risk sentiment. Rather than presenting markets as a collection of isolated trades, the project frames market analysis as a connected process in which idea generation, risk management, and performance review all influence one another.

The work is grounded in a practical review framework used across approximately **20 trades per week** and supports **8 independent clients** or portfolios with account sizes typically ranging from **$2,500 to $4,000**. Within this framework, risk per trade is capped at 0.5%, trade ideas are filtered through a minimum target **risk-reward ratio of 1:2**, and outcomes are reviewed using metrics such as profit factor, Sharpe ratio range, and discipline quality.

The purpose of the project is not to claim institutional trading experience. Instead, it demonstrates market curiosity, disciplined thinking, and evidence of the exact processes often referenced in global markets roles: monitoring markets, developing trade ideas, reviewing exposure, understanding event risk, and communicating decisions clearly.

Project snapshot

Dimension	Coverage	Process	Key Output
Markets	FX and commodities	Macro + technical + risk framework	Trade ideas, weekly reviews, case studies

1. Project Purpose and Design

The project was built to function as a high-quality portfolio artifact that demonstrates markets interest through process, structure, and documentation rather than code. It is intentionally designed as a casebook instead of a slide deck only, because a casebook allows the reader to evaluate not just the final conclusions but also the quality of reasoning behind them.

A strong markets project should show more than directional opinions. It should show what was observed, why a trade idea was formed, how risk was defined, which scenarios could invalidate the view, how exposure was monitored, and what was learned after the trade was closed or reviewed. This casebook therefore mirrors a disciplined review cycle rather than a collection of ad hoc trade screenshots.

2. Scope of Market Coverage

The scope is deliberately focused on liquid, macro-sensitive instruments that are suitable for disciplined monitoring and repeatable review. Coverage remains broad enough to show cross-asset awareness while narrow enough to allow consistency and depth.

- FX instruments covered regularly: EUR/USD, GBP/USD, USD/JPY.
- Commodity instruments covered regularly: Gold, Silver, Crude Oil.
- Reference context monitored alongside these assets: inflation releases, central bank decisions, labour-market data, bond-yield shifts, US dollar strength or weakness, geopolitical headlines, and commodity supply-side developments.
- The casebook prioritises instruments where macro catalysts and technical execution can both be observed clearly, allowing trade ideas to be linked to a visible market thesis rather than arbitrary price movement.

3. Analytical Workflow

The review process follows five connected stages. Each stage has a distinct purpose and helps ensure that trade decisions are evidence-based and measurable.

Stage 1 - Market Monitoring: At the start of the review cycle, markets are screened for event risk, emerging macro narratives, volatility conditions, and price structure. The aim is not to predict everything; it is to identify where market attention is likely to concentrate.

Stage 2 - Trade Idea Generation: Potential opportunities are identified when a macro catalyst aligns with a technical setup. Each idea must have a clear directional thesis, an entry zone, an invalidation point, a target, and a defined risk-reward profile before being considered actionable.

Stage 3 - Position and Exposure Review: Existing and prospective positions are checked for concentration risk, correlation risk, and event sensitivity. This step helps prevent overexposure, especially where multiple trades are effectively expressing the same macro view.

Stage 4 - Risk Management and Execution Discipline: Position size is aligned to a fixed risk cap per trade, stop-loss placement is determined before entry, and target reward is assessed relative to downside. If the setup cannot support disciplined risk management, it is filtered out.

Stage 5 - Post-Trade Evaluation: Every closed or reviewed trade is examined to determine whether the original thesis was valid, whether execution quality supported the thesis, and whether the outcome reflected process quality or simply randomness.

4. Operating Metrics and Risk Framework

The following operating assumptions and review metrics define the project. They are not presented as marketing claims but as parameters that shape how ideas are filtered, measured, and documented.

Metric	Value	Interpretation
Clients / portfolios supported	8	Shows that market review was not a purely private exercise and that analysis had to be communicated for decision support.
Average trades reviewed per week	20	Creates enough repetition for pattern recognition, discipline checks, and weekly process review.
Asset classes covered	FX and commodities	A focused scope that supports depth in macro-sensitive instruments.
Portfolio size range	$2,500-$4,000	Suitable for disciplined position sizing and repeatable risk control.
Risk limit per trade	0.5%	Supports capital preservation and reduces behavioural error during volatility.

Review Metrics Used for Ongoing Process Control

Metric	Value	Interpretation
Target risk-reward ratio	1:2	Ensures upside potential is meaningfully larger than defined downside.
Profit factor	1.0	Used here as a review metric rather than a marketing statistic; indicates the need for ongoing process refinement.
Sharpe ratio range	0.5-1.0	Provides a simple risk-adjusted frame for assessing consistency rather than only gross outcomes.
3-5-7 rule	Rule-based discipline framework	Used as an internal discipline filter to assess setup quality, patience, and review consistency.

5. Trade Idea Development Framework

Trade ideas in this project are generated through the interaction of macro catalysts and technical structure. A macro view without execution discipline can result in poor timing; a technical breakout without a macro thesis can result in fragile conviction. The framework therefore requires both components to be present before an idea is considered high quality.

The process begins with identifying a market-moving narrative: for example, stronger-than-expected inflation, a central bank tone shift, deteriorating risk sentiment, or an oil supply shock. The next step is to assess whether price action supports the thesis through trend continuation, breakout, rejection, or support-resistance behaviour. Only after both conditions are present is the trade framed in terms of entry, stop, target, and scenario risk.

Trade Idea Filters

- The idea must be linked to a recognisable catalyst rather than price movement in isolation.
- The technical structure must provide a clear invalidation level, enabling disciplined stop-loss placement.
- The reward target must be sufficient to support a minimum 1:2 risk-reward ratio.
- The trade should not create excessive correlated exposure when viewed against existing positions.
- High-risk event windows should be treated carefully unless the setup explicitly accounts for event volatility.
- The rationale must be explainable in concise written language suitable for client or stakeholder review.

How Ideas Were Generated in Practice

In practice, trade ideas were developed by screening FX and commodities for the combination of macro relevance, technical clarity, and manageable event risk. The following tactics were used repeatedly:

- Monitoring inflation prints, labour-market data, and central bank guidance to identify likely US dollar, rates-sensitive, or precious-metals reactions.
- Tracking commodity-specific catalysts such as oil supply developments or broader risk-off moves that could alter the relative attractiveness of gold or crude oil.
- Using support, resistance, breakout zones, and momentum confirmation to refine entry logic.
- Comparing the distance to stop-loss and take-profit levels to ensure position size remained consistent with the 0.5% risk cap.
- Filtering out setups with weak confirmation, unfavourable reward relative to risk, or poor timing ahead of scheduled event risk.

6. Portfolio Exposure and Position Review

A key part of this casebook is the treatment of positions as a portfolio rather than as isolated trades. This matters because several trades can appear diversified while still expressing the same macro thesis. For example, a strong US dollar view may simultaneously affect EUR/USD, GBP/USD, and gold. Without exposure review, the portfolio can become concentrated unintentionally.

The portfolio review framework therefore examines concentration risk, correlation risk, and event sensitivity before and after trades are taken. The objective is to determine not only whether a trade is individually attractive, but also whether it improves or weakens the quality of the total portfolio.

Core Portfolio Review Questions

- Is the portfolio overly exposed to a single macro narrative such as US dollar strength, falling yields, or commodity supply risk?
- Are multiple positions correlated even if they sit in different instruments?
- Does the current exposure profile still respect the fixed risk discipline across all live or recently reviewed trades?
- Would a single scheduled event, such as NFP or a central bank decision, affect too many positions at once?
- Are the best-performing setups coming from a consistent pattern, and are the weaker setups exposing recurring process errors?

7. Post-Trade Review and Performance Evaluation

Post-trade review is included because outcomes alone do not adequately measure decision quality. A trade can make money for the wrong reasons, and a valid thesis can fail because timing or execution was poor. The casebook therefore separates thesis quality, execution quality, and final outcome.

Each trade entry includes space for a post-trade note that records whether the original catalyst remained valid, whether entry timing respected the plan, whether event risk was handled properly, and what lesson should be carried forward into future reviews.

Performance Review Lens

- Profit factor is used to understand whether gross gains sufficiently offset gross losses over time.
- Sharpe ratio range is used as a simple risk-adjusted frame to evaluate whether returns are generated with reasonable consistency.
- Average target risk-reward provides a discipline checkpoint rather than a guarantee of results.
- Trade frequency and setup quality are reviewed together to avoid overtrading low-conviction ideas.
- Common error categories are documented to support deliberate process improvement.

8. The 3-5-7 Rule: Suggested Interpretation for Project Use

Because the 3-5-7 rule is not a universal market standard term, this document defines it clearly for project use so that readers can understand how it supports discipline. It may be presented as a personal rule-based structure for filtering and reviewing trades.

- 3 = Three mandatory checks before considering a trade: catalyst clarity, technical confirmation, and acceptable risk-reward.
- 5 = Five review dimensions for every position: thesis, timing, sizing, event risk, and portfolio correlation.
- 7 = Seven-day or seven-session learning cycle for recurring review: capture trade outcome, compare against thesis, classify mistake or strength, review exposure, refine rules, update journal, and carry forward the next action.

This interpretation turns the phrase into a practical quality-control framework rather than a vague slogan. It can be referenced in the README, the project overview, and the portfolio review template to show consistency.

9. Trade Journal Template and Sample Entries

The trade journal is the operational centre of the project. It records idea generation, exposure logic, and post-trade learning in one place. The sample entries below show how the journal should be populated.

Date	Asset	Bias	Catalyst	Entry Logic	Risk %	R:R	Outcome	Lesson
14 Jan 2026	EUR/USD	Short	Stronger USD after inflation surprise	Break below support with momentum confirmation	0.5	1:2	Target hit	Macro and technicals aligned well
22 Jan 2026	Gold	Long	Risk-off sentiment and softer yield expectations	Bounce from key daily support	0.5	1:2	Stopped out	Wait for stronger confirmation before entry
05 Feb 2026	Crude Oil	Long	Supply concerns after supply-side headlines	Continuation above breakout zone	0.5	1:2	Partial target	Execution good; trailing logic could improve

10. Weekly Portfolio Review Template

The portfolio review should summarise what happened across the week, where exposure was concentrated, which setup types worked best, and what actions should be taken in the next cycle.

Review period: State the exact weekly range being assessed.

Activity summary: Record total trades reviewed, split by FX and commodities, and note the number of clients or portfolios supported.

Exposure review: Identify the largest exposure pockets, correlated positions, and whether one macro view dominated the portfolio.

Setup quality review: Distinguish between strong setups and weak setups to identify what the process should favour in future.

Risk review: Check whether the 0.5% rule, reward-to-risk discipline, and event-risk controls were maintained.

Performance review: Summarise profit factor, Sharpe range, and discipline quality rather than only realised P&L.

Lessons and actions: List the two to four most useful lessons and define specific adjustments for the next review cycle.

11. Market Event Case Studies

The case studies below are tied to dated recent market events so the project reads like a current markets portfolio rather than a generic theory note. Each study links the event, affected assets, trade bias, scenario analysis, risk controls, and post-event review.

Case Study 1 - USD and Gold Reaction to the Federal Reserve Decision | 28 January 2026

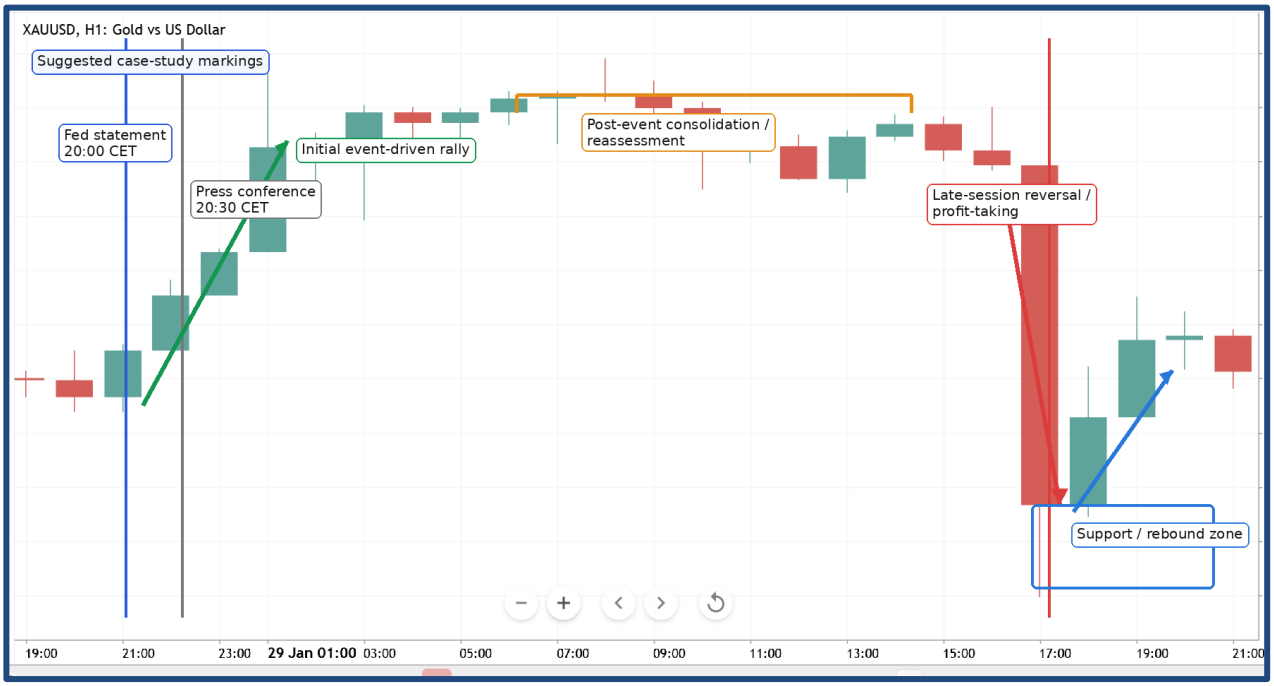
Background: On 28 January 2026, the Federal Reserve kept the federal funds target range unchanged at 3.50%–3.75%. For market participants, the significance was less about the hold itself and more about how the decision shaped US dollar strength, real-rate expectations, and safe-haven positioning across gold and rate-sensitive assets.

What happened: A policy hold at a still-restrictive level reinforced a higher-for-longer interpretation. That backdrop generally supported the US dollar and kept pressure on non-yielding assets, while gold remained sensitive to any shift in real-yield expectations. The event therefore offered a useful cross-asset review: if yields stayed firm, gold longs became less attractive; if the market interpreted the tone as less hawkish than feared, gold could stabilise despite the unchanged rate.

Trade idea: The working idea was to assess conditional bias rather than force a single direction. A stronger-dollar, higher-yield reaction would favour a tactical short bias in gold or a defensive long-USD bias in FX. A softer follow-through would justify waiting for gold to hold support before considering a mean-reversion long. Entry rationale depended on confirmation from price around key support-resistance zones, with stop-loss and target levels structured to preserve the 0.5% risk cap and a minimum 1:2 reward-to-risk profile.

Risk considerations: The main risk was misreading the market's second-round reaction. Fed decisions often create an initial move that reverses once the statement and press interpretation are fully absorbed. Scenario analysis therefore had to include a whipsaw case, a stable-yields case, and a softer-dollar case. Position size had to remain small enough to protect against post-announcement volatility.

Review lesson: This case study shows why central-bank events should be traded through disciplined conditional frameworks rather than opinion alone. The market does not only react to the decision; it reacts to how the decision changes expectations for future rates, inflation, and the US dollar.



Case Study 2 - Crude Oil Outlook After the OPEC+ Production Decision | 1 March 2026

Background: On 1 March 2026, eight OPEC+ countries said they had reviewed global market conditions and outlook and reaffirmed their commitment to market stability while adjusting production. For crude oil, this mattered because supply messaging can quickly reshape expectations around balances, inflation transmission, and commodity-linked sentiment.

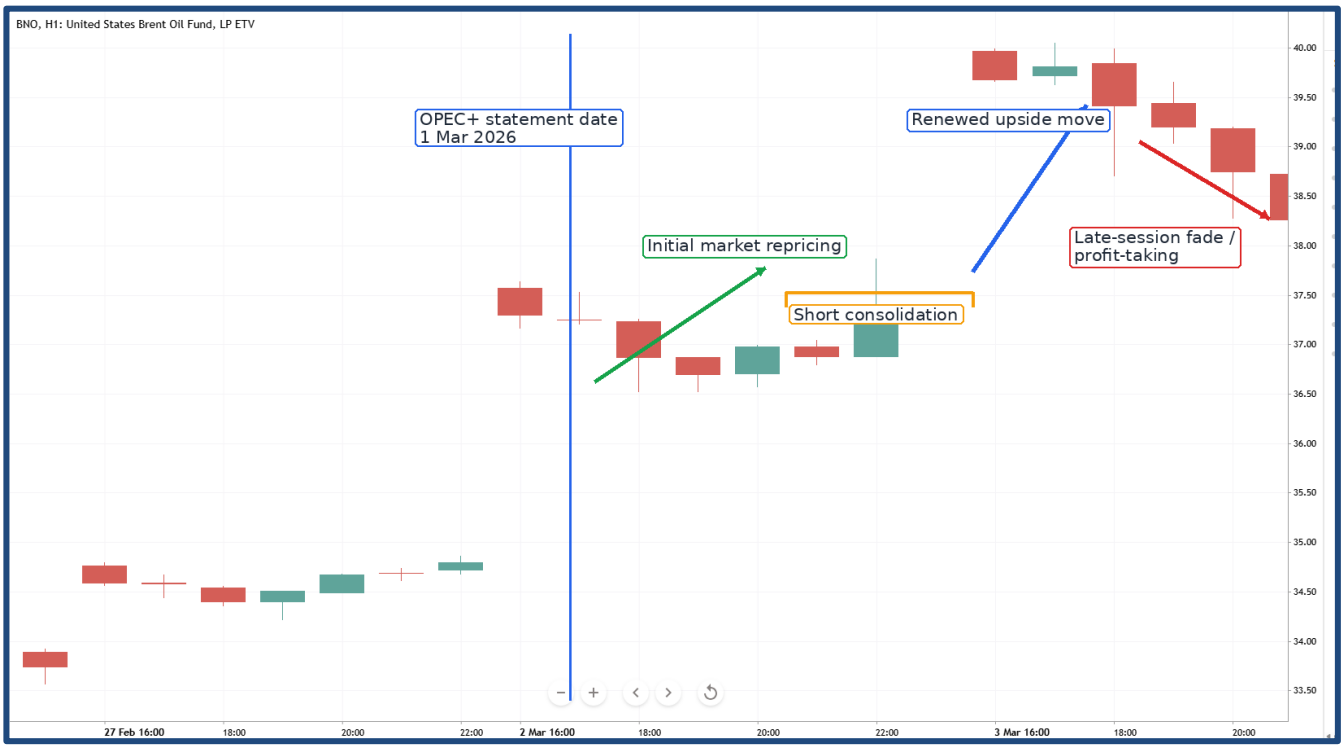
What happened: The announcement supported the idea that supply management would remain an active policy lever. Even where the immediate price response is measured, the policy signal matters because it affects how traders frame forward supply tightness, spare capacity assumptions, and the probability of future inventory stress. In portfolio terms, the event was relevant not only for crude itself but also for inflation-sensitive trades and FX exposures linked to broader risk sentiment.

Trade idea: The preferred setup was a conditional long bias if crude held above an important breakout or retest zone after the announcement. Entry logic relied on waiting for confirmation that price could absorb the headline without immediate reversal. Scenario planning included a continuation case, a failed-breakout case, and a risk-off demand-destruction case. Any trade would still have to satisfy the 0.5% risk limit and the 1:2 reward-to-risk threshold.

Risk considerations: OPEC-driven moves can fade if broader macro conditions deteriorate or if traders judge the production signal as already priced. The position therefore needed to be reviewed against other inflation, USD, or commodity exposures to avoid concentration risk. Event risk around inventories and geopolitical headlines also remained relevant.

Review lesson: The case highlights that commodity trades should not be evaluated purely through direction. A stronger review framework asks whether the supply headline changed the distribution of outcomes enough to justify the trade, and whether the position still made sense once cross-asset exposure was considered.

BNO was used as a Brent-linked market proxy due to platform instrument availability.



Case Study 3 - EUR/USD After the ECB Rate Hold and Energy-Driven Inflation Risks | 19 March 2026

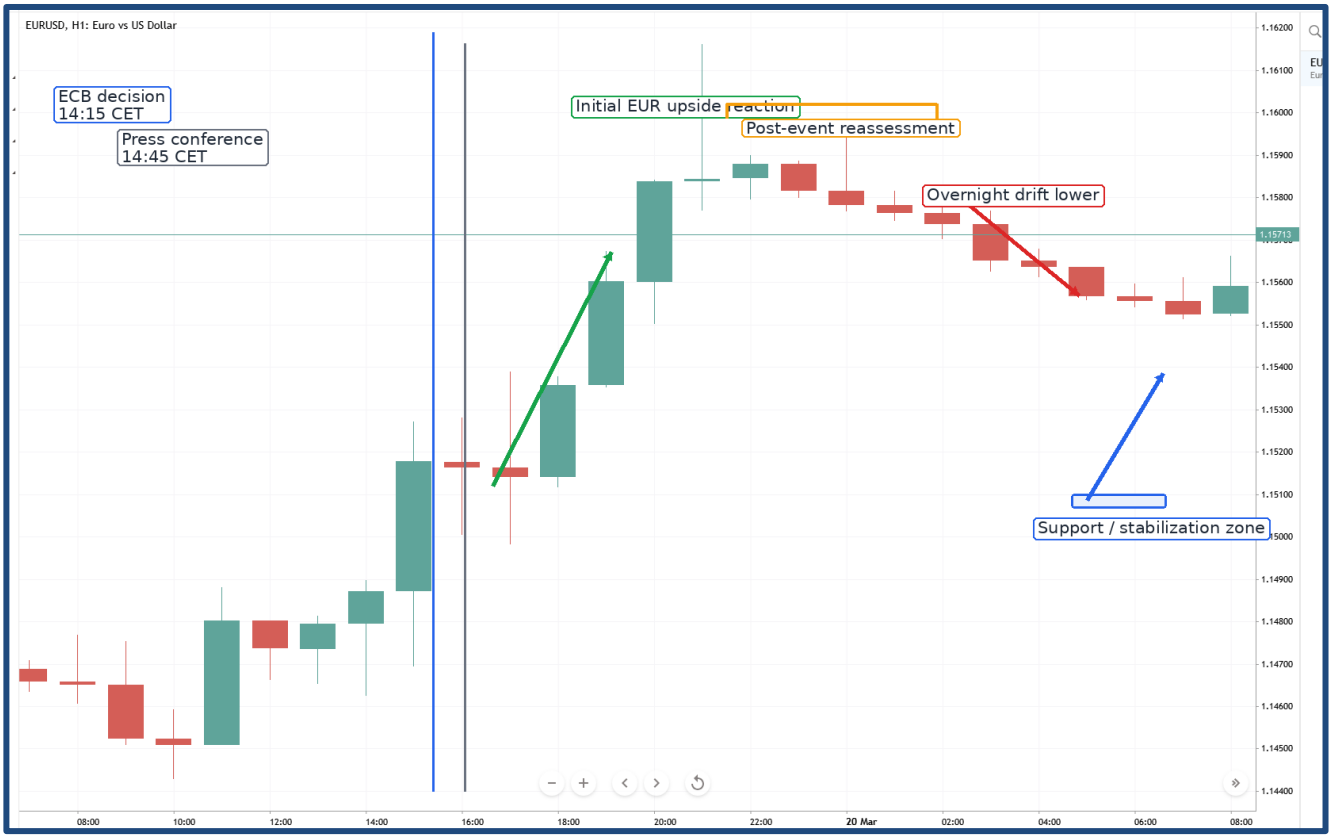
Background: On 19 March 2026, the European Central Bank left its key rates unchanged and said energy prices were expected to be higher because of the war in the Middle East. That combination mattered for EUR/USD because it introduced a difficult mix of upside inflation risk and downside growth risk for the euro area, while also affecting how relative policy expectations versus the United States were priced.

What happened: The event reinforced a more complex EUR view. Higher energy prices can worsen Europe's terms of trade and weigh on growth, while sticky inflation can delay the policy path investors had been expecting. For EUR/USD, that means the pair can face pressure not just from dollar strength but also from the euro area's greater vulnerability to imported energy shocks. The market reaction therefore had to be interpreted through both rates and regional growth sensitivity.

Trade idea: A cautious bearish EUR/USD bias was justified if price action confirmed that the market was leaning toward weaker euro growth and firmer relative US support. The setup required a clean break or rejection around a technical level rather than a narrative-only short. Position sizing had to reflect the possibility of sharp reversals if the market focused instead on sticky inflation and a potentially less dovish ECB path.

Risk considerations: The main risks were a reversal driven by dollar weakness, a change in war-related energy pricing, or a market interpretation that the ECB would need to stay tighter for longer. Exposure also needed to be reviewed against gold and oil because the same energy shock could affect several positions at once.

Review lesson: This case is useful because it shows how one headline can influence a currency through multiple channels at the same time. Good market analysis requires separating the inflation effect, the growth effect, and the cross-asset correlation effect before deciding whether the trade thesis is truly robust.



Case Study 4 - Geopolitical Conflict, Energy Shock, and Cross-Asset Market Reaction | 1-20 March 2026

Background: The escalation of conflict in the Middle East during March 2026 created a high-conviction geopolitical-risk case study because it affected oil supply expectations, shipping risk, inflation assumptions, and safe-haven demand at the same time. This was not only a commodity story; it was a cross-asset event with implications for crude oil, gold, the US dollar, and Europe-sensitive FX pairs.

What happened: As the conflict intensified, energy infrastructure and shipping risk became central to market pricing. Disruption risk around the Strait of Hormuz and strikes affecting regional energy facilities pushed oil higher and increased concern about inflation spillovers. At the same time, the event created headline-driven volatility across gold and currency markets. The analytical value of the case lies in understanding how one geopolitical shock can transmit simultaneously through supply, inflation, growth expectations, and defensive positioning.

Trade Idea: The highest-quality idea in such an environment was not to chase every headline, but to structure conditional exposure. A tactical long-oil bias could be considered if supply disruption risk remained unresolved and price held above breakout support. A selective gold long could be justified if safe-haven flows strengthened without an offsetting surge in real yields. EUR/USD warranted a cautious bearish bias if Europe's energy sensitivity became the dominant narrative. Because war-driven markets can gap and reverse quickly, reduced size, wider scenario planning, and strict adherence to the 0.5% risk cap were essential.

Risk Considerations: War-related trades carry extraordinary headline risk, reversal risk, and correlation risk. Diplomacy, ceasefire rumours, military escalation, or emergency policy responses can reverse price action abruptly. Portfolio review therefore had to assess whether multiple positions were effectively the same bet expressed through different instruments such as oil, gold, and EUR/USD. This case strongly reinforced the importance of scenario analysis, smaller position sizing, and avoiding overconfidence in narrative-driven moves.

Review Lesson: The core lesson is that geopolitical events can create powerful trade ideas, but only if they are treated as probability distributions rather than certainties. The most professional response is not aggressive prediction; it is disciplined framing, controlled exposure, and clear communication of both upside thesis and downside risk.

11. Appendix A: Trade Idea Journal (Selected Entries)

Purpose. This appendix provides a curated journal rather than a full retail-style log. Each entry is designed to demonstrate structured market monitoring, conditional trade-idea development, risk framing, and post-event review discipline. The emphasis is on process quality, not on maximizing the number of entries.

How to read this appendix. Entries are organized as selected market-review notes around the four core case studies in the project. Some entries represent a live trade idea; others are portfolio-management or de-risking notes. This is intentional and reflects how markets work in practice.

Journal fields used throughout: market bias, catalyst, setup, entry logic, stop-loss logic, take-profit logic, scenario analysis, risk treatment, outcome, and review lesson.

Entry 1 | XAU/USD | Fed Hold and Gold Reaction

Date	28 Jan 2026
Market bias	Tactical long into event reaction, then reassess post-statement
Catalyst	FOMC decision (20:00 CET) and press conference (20:30 CET)
Setup	Event-driven breakout / volatility expansion
Entry logic	Wait for the first directional H1 close after the statement; avoid pre-commitment before release.
Stop-loss logic	Below the immediate post-statement invalidation zone or below the prior reaction low.
Take-profit logic	Initial target at prior intraday resistance, with secondary target at 1:2 R:R if momentum extends.
Risk treatment	0.5% max risk; reduced size because event volatility can produce slippage.
Scenario analysis	Bullish if gold holds post-statement gains and USD softens. Neutral to bearish if real yields reprice higher and the initial spike fades.
Outcome / review	Initial upside reaction followed by later retracement; thesis valid but required disciplined reassessment after the first impulse.
Lesson	During central-bank events, the best trade is often the cleanest reaction after confirmation, not the first emotional move.

Entry 2 | EUR/USD | ECB Hold and Euro Reassessment

Date	19 Mar 2026
Market bias	Conditional long on initial EUR strength, with reassessment into press conference.
Catalyst	ECB decision (14:15 CET) and press conference (14:45 CET)
Setup	Policy-event reaction with peak-and-fade risk
Entry logic	Monitor for upside continuation if the first post-decision hour closes above resistance and press-conference tone remains supportive.
Stop-loss logic	Below breakout level / event support zone.
Take-profit logic	Scale out at the event high; extended target only if the euro continues to hold gains overnight.
Risk treatment	0.5% risk cap; avoid over-allocation because EUR/USD can reverse sharply when the press-conference message shifts.
Scenario analysis	Supportive if inflation-risk messaging is balanced and growth concerns do not dominate. Bearish if policy caution and energy-driven inflation concerns trigger reassessment.
Outcome / review	Strong initial EUR upside reaction followed by post-event reassessment and overnight drift lower.
Lesson	Policy headlines can lift price quickly, but the press conference often determines whether the first move becomes a trend or a fade.

Entry 3 | BNO | OPEC+ Statement as Brent-Linked Proxy

Date	1 Mar 2026
Market bias	Tactical bullish bias on supply/stability narrative with proxy instrument.
Catalyst	OPEC+ statement and market-stability messaging
Setup	Initial repricing, short consolidation, and renewed upside move
Entry logic	Use BNO as a Brent-linked proxy due to platform instrument availability; enter only after the first consolidation holds above support.
Stop-loss logic	Below the consolidation floor or the most recent higher low.
Take-profit logic	First target at the next resistance zone, then reassess continuation potential.
Risk treatment	0.5% risk cap with awareness that fund proxies can lag or compress the underlying crude move.
Scenario analysis	Bullish if the statement reinforces supply discipline and the market prices tighter conditions. Neutral if the reaction remains muted or fades quickly.
Outcome / review	Proxy chart showed initial repricing, consolidation, follow-through, and later profit-taking.
Lesson	When direct underlying instruments are unavailable, a documented proxy can still support the case study if the limitations are stated clearly.

Entry 4 | XAU/USD | Geopolitical Conflict and Cross-Asset Volatility

Date	18–20 Mar 2026
Market bias	Selective safe-haven long only if gold strengthens without a dominant USD / real-yield offset.
Catalyst	Escalation in Middle East conflict, shipping and energy-risk concerns
Setup	Headline-driven volatility with sharp intraday reversals
Entry logic	Wait for stabilization after the initial shock; avoid chasing the first violent move. Use confirmation from hold above short-term support or reversal structure.
Stop-loss logic	Below the stabilization zone / invalidation swing low.
Take-profit logic	Modest tactical target; reduce ambition because headline risk can reverse the move abruptly.
Risk treatment	0.5% max risk, reduced size, wider scenarios, and no clustering with strongly correlated positions.
Scenario analysis	Supportive if safe-haven demand dominates. Bearish if the USD and yield complex strengthen enough to cap or reverse gold.
Outcome / review	Multi-session volatility with rebounds and renewed downside pressure as safe-haven demand interacted with dollar dynamics.
Lesson	Geopolitical trades must be framed as scenario-based exposures, not convictions that every headline will extend the same direction.

Entry 5 | EUR/USD | Europe Energy Sensitivity

Date	20 Mar 2026
Market bias	Cautious bearish bias on Europe-sensitive FX under energy-shock narrative.
Catalyst	War-related energy concerns and inflation-growth spillover risks
Setup	Fade of relief rallies within a broader cautious tone
Entry logic	Consider short bias only after failed recovery attempts and confirmation that the market continues to price growth concerns more heavily than temporary relief.
Stop-loss logic	Above the failed recovery high.
Take-profit logic	Prior intraday support or 1:2 R:R, whichever comes first.
Risk treatment	0.5% risk cap; avoid duplicate exposure if already positioned through gold or oil-sensitive themes.
Scenario analysis	Bearish if Europe's energy sensitivity remains central. Neutral if risk sentiment improves and EUR stabilizes despite energy headlines.
Outcome / review	FX positioning required caution because correlations with other geopolitical exposures increased.
Lesson	In cross-asset events, portfolio review matters as much as the single trade idea because multiple instruments can express the same macro view.

Entry 6 | XAU/USD | Post-Event Fade Review

Date	29 Jan 2026
Market bias	Counter-momentum short only after failure to sustain event gains.
Catalyst	Reassessment after Fed reaction and price failure to hold highs
Setup	Exhaustion / fade after event-driven rally
Entry logic	Only after lower high formation and weak continuation candles following the event impulse.
Stop-loss logic	Above the exhaustion high.
Take-profit logic	Return to the reaction support area or a 1:2 R:R outcome.
Risk treatment	Reduced size because fading strong event moves can be lower-probability without clear confirmation.
Scenario analysis	Bearish if rally fails and USD firms. Invalid if buyers reassert control and reclaim the highs.
Outcome / review	Late-session reversal and profit-taking created a cleaner fade setup than the initial post-event impulse.
Lesson	The second, calmer setup after a major event can be more tradable than the first explosive move.

Entry 7 | EUR/USD | Overnight Drift Management

Date	19–20 Mar 2026
Market bias	Manage rather than force continuation after event high.
Catalyst	Post-ECB reassessment during overnight session
Setup	Drift lower after initial EUR strength
Entry logic	This was more a portfolio-management note than a fresh trade: protect gains when price begins to fade from the event high and momentum weakens.
Stop-loss logic	Trailing invalidation above the recovery highs if holding any residual long exposure.
Take-profit logic	Use structure-based exit into the overnight drift rather than waiting for an extended target.
Risk treatment	Tightened risk through partial de-risking instead of adding exposure.
Scenario analysis	Continuation lower if policy caution dominates. Stabilization if support forms and the market decides the first sell-off was excessive.
Outcome / review	The overnight move favored disciplined de-risking over aggressive continuation chasing.
Lesson	Not every journal entry needs a new trade; good portfolio review often means reducing risk when the information edge deteriorates.

Entry 8 | BNO | Profit-Taking After Proxy Follow-Through

Date	3 Mar 2026
Market bias	Take profits into strength rather than forcing trend extension.
Catalyst	Follow-through after OPEC+ repricing
Setup	Trend continuation losing momentum
Entry logic	No fresh long once price extends after the clean initial reaction; focus shifts to exit quality and avoiding emotional re-entry.
Stop-loss logic	N/A for no new position; review exit discipline instead.
Take-profit logic	Lock profits into visible extension and reassess only after a new base forms.
Risk treatment	Risk managed through reduced exposure and avoidance of late chasing.
Scenario analysis	Healthy if price consolidates above prior support; vulnerable if the move becomes overextended and participants begin to fade it.
Outcome / review	Late-session fade / profit-taking validated the decision not to chase the extended move.
Lesson	Good journals record where not to trade, not just where to trade.

Weekly Portfolio Review Summaries

Weekly Portfolio Review | 27 Jan 2026 – 31 Jan 2026

Trades / ideas reviewed	20
Primary assets	XAU/USD, EUR/USD, USD-sensitive macro reactions
Best-quality setup	Confirmed post-event continuation only after first directional close
Weakest behavior	Temptation to chase the initial reaction before structure formed
Risk discipline	0.5% per trade cap maintained; reduced size around FOMC
Review conclusion	The week reinforced that central-bank reactions require patience, event-specific scenario planning, and post-release confirmation.

Weekly Portfolio Review | 17 Mar 2026 – 21 Mar 2026

Trades / ideas reviewed	20
Primary assets	XAU/USD, EUR/USD, BNO proxy
Cross-asset theme	Geopolitical risk, energy shock, ECB communication, USD sensitivity
Main portfolio issue	Potential correlation overlap between gold, Europe-sensitive FX, and oil-linked risk expressions
Risk discipline	Smaller size, broader scenarios, emphasis on avoiding duplicate macro exposure
Review conclusion	The week highlighted how quickly one geopolitical theme can flow through commodities, FX, and safe-haven assets, making portfolio review essential.

Disclaimer: This project is for educational and portfolio purposes only and does not constitute investment advice, a solicitation to trade, or a representation of institutional trading activity.